

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Math	Algebra	Linear equations in two variables	Hard

Question

In the xy -plane, line k is defined by $x + y = 0$. Line j is perpendicular to line k , and the y -intercept of line j is $(0,3)$. Which of the following is an equation of line j ?

Answer

- A. $x + y = 3$
- B. $x + y = -3$
- C. $x - y = 3$
- D. $x - y = -3$

Correct Answer: D

Rationale

Choice D is correct. It’s given that line j is perpendicular to line k and that line k is defined by the equation $x + y = 0$. This equation can be rewritten in slope-intercept form, $y = mx + b$, where m represents the slope of the line and b represents the y -coordinate of the y -intercept of the line, by subtracting x from both sides of the equation, which yields $y = -x$. Thus, the slope of line k is -1 . Since line j and line k are perpendicular, their slopes are opposite reciprocals of each other. Thus, the slope of line j is 1 . It’s given that the y -intercept of line j is $(0,3)$. Therefore, the equation for line j in slope-intercept form is $y = x + 3$, which can be rewritten as $x - y = -3$.

Choices A, B, and C are incorrect and may result from conceptual or calculation errors.